Collective Guide

For leaders, co-leaders, and table leaders of the Men's and Women's Collectives

THANK YOU FOR LEADING

Thank you for helping people find encouragement and grow in Christ. You don't carry a Collective alone. Co-leaders and table leaders share the work, Paul prepares the study resources and cares for leaders, and Russ and the pastoral team step in when a need goes beyond your role. Policies live in one place, the GCC Group Leader Agreement. This guide covers the rest.

WHAT A COLLECTIVE IS AND ISN'T

Collectives are places of shared encouragement, where men walk alongside men and women alongside women as they study Scripture and pray together. We hope these friendships grow into mentoring, honesty, and mutual care.

- It is teaching and conversation together. People take part instead of only listening.
- It has more shared study than a City Group's flexible gathering.
- The Men's and Women's Collectives share a course direction, but each uses resources suited to its own people. Don't assume everyone has the same story or needs the same application.
- It supports Sunday worship and the church's pastoral care. It doesn't replace them.
- You help people take part. No one expects you to be a counselor or to have every answer.

BELONGING, BEHOLDING, BECOMING

Belonging is being welcomed into relationship with God and his people. **Beholding** is attending to Jesus through Scripture, prayer, worship, and dependence on the Holy Spirit. **Becoming** is growing into his likeness in everyday love, obedience, service, and witness. Someone who is welcomed can begin to speak honestly, Scripture brings that honesty before Christ, and prayer carries it into the week. The Spirit gives the growth. Your part is to prepare faithfully and make room for people to respond to Christ.

THE GATHERING FLOW

Most gatherings follow five steps. Adjust them to your group and your study plan.

1. **Connection.** Welcome people, introduce newcomers, and check in.
2. **Context and review.** Recall the last gathering and show where today's passage sits in the book, so anyone who missed last time or is new can pick up the study's focus quickly.
3. **Part 1: teaching or devotional, then discussion.** Open your Bibles, explain the first part of the passage from the text, then ask open questions that help people connect it with their lives.
4. **Part 2: teaching or devotional, then discussion.** Do the same with the second part.
5. **Regroup and pray.** Share final thoughts and prayer requests, pray together, and remind people of the next gathering.

The flow follows S.O.A.P. (Scripture, Observation, Application, Prayer), moving from what the passage says to how it shapes our lives. Keep each teaching part short so discussion has real room. You don't need to carry the evening, and people engage more when more voices are heard. Use tables or one group conversation,

depending on attendance.

BEFORE YOU LEAD

- Read the passage and the current handout. Find the main point, what needs explaining, and a few questions that invite a response. Pray for the people who will come.
- Agree with your co-leader who will welcome, teach, lead discussion, keep time, and close. Give table leaders enough background to serve the same purpose.
- Before a new Collective or a new leader begins, sit down with Paul and the First Meetings Checklist to go over the role, schedule, location, study plan, safeguards, and how people will join.
- Read the GCC Group Leader Agreement and sign its Leader Acknowledgement. Interest, training, or a Planning Center role doesn't by itself make someone a leader.

STEERING THE CONVERSATION

Start with what people notice in the passage before asking how it touches their lives, and give them time to think. Invite quieter people without requiring an answer. To bring a tangent back, try "That's worth coming back to afterward. For now, how does it connect with what the passage says here?" "I don't know yet" is a fine answer. Bring disputed teaching to the teaching leader, Paul, or Russ, and stay with the agreed study (Policy 11).

When someone shares something painful, stop and care; the study can wait. Listen without pressing for details or making them explain to the room, offer to pray, and point them to pastoral support (Policy 7). Men care for men and women for women, so follow-up across genders goes through a co-leader of the same gender or a pastor (Policy 12).

DEBRIEF AFTER THE GATHERING

Take a few minutes with your co-leader before the week moves on. Talk through what helped people take part, what needs attention, and who needs follow-up. Take attendance the way Paul has asked, and tell him about any wrong details on the event page. Act on an urgent concern right away, and keep care details with the pastoral contact instead of in chats or shared notes.

BOUNDARIES AND PACE

The agreement covers confidentiality, prayer requests, conflict, conduct, homes, children, alcohol, money, and urgent situations.

- A meeting address can go on the Planning Center group profile, which only group members see. Send other personal details by email or the Church Center group chat, never publicly.
- Ask before you share a prayer request, and keep stories and care details out of group chats (Policies 5, 6, and 17).
- Use email as the main way to reach members so people without the Church Center app aren't missed.
- Fundraising, exceptions to policy, and commitments beyond your role need the church's approval first (Policies 8 and 11).
- Share the load with your co-leader and table leaders, and talk with Paul when preparation or capacity gets hard to sustain. You can step back for a season without shame. Small numbers or uneven attendance don't disqualify you as a leader or take anything from your faithful service.

YOUR SUPPORT SYSTEM

- **Your co-leader and table leaders** prepare, lead, and debrief with you.

- **Paul**, Ministry Director for Groups and Classes, prepares the study resources and is your first call for questions about your Collective or your own capacity. Book one-on-one time through his sign-up calendar.
- **Group Leader Collaboration** brings current leaders together on the first and third Saturday mornings of each month. Leaders across the ministry serve in different rooms, often at the same hour, and rarely see one another at work. At Collaboration you share what's working and what's hard, learn from each other, and come away encouraged and better equipped. Paul posts times and places in the leaders' Church Center group chat.
- **Russ and the pastoral team** step in when care goes beyond what the group can give.

WHEN YOU NEED HELP

In an emergency, call 911 first. Then tell Russ Daly, Lead Pastor and primary pastoral contact, the same day, or Paul as backup if you can't reach Russ. You'll receive their numbers privately. Don't investigate or carry a serious situation alone. The GCC Group Leader Agreement gives the full response for each case below.

IF…	FIRST STEP	AGREEMENT
Someone's life or safety is in immediate danger	Call 911	Policy 1
You suspect abuse or neglect of a child or vulnerable adult	Don't investigate or promise secrecy; tell Russ the same day	Policy 2
Someone speaks of suicide or self-harm	Stay with them; share 988; tell Russ the same day	Policy 3
Someone discloses violence or abuse at home	Put their safety first; tell Russ the same day	Policy 4
Grief, illness, or a struggle bigger than the group	Pray, stay close, and refer them to a pastor	Policy 7
Someone asks for money	Listen with care and refer them to Russ	Policy 8
Ongoing disruption or conflict	Talk privately; bring in Paul	Policies 9 and 10
A concern about a fellow leader's conduct	Tell Russ	Policy 12

Telling the church never replaces a report the law requires (Policy 2).

KEEP THESE CLOSE

- GCC Group Leader Agreement: policies, emergency responses, and pastoral contacts.
- resources.goldencity.church: Weekly Recaps and other Groups resources.